

Woman's Hour

– BBC Radio 4



Image from <https://www.bbc.co.uk/programmes/b007qlvb>

AS Component 1: Investigating the Media

A level Component 1: Media products, industries and audiences

Focus areas:

- **Media industries**
- **Audiences**
- **Media contexts**

PRODUCT CONTEXT

- *Woman's Hour* is a long-running BBC Radio 4 daily **magazine programme**. The first edition was broadcast in October 1946 on the BBC's Light Programme. This was a station which broadcast entertainment programmes and music from 1945 to 1967 and was originally presented by a man, Alan Ivimey. Early episodes were thought by some women to be patronising, focusing on the role of the housewife with features including 'mother's midday meal' and 'how to hang your husband's suit'. The programme has evolved to cover hard-hitting topics including abortion, domestic violence and equal pay, alongside lighter elements including why there is no body hair on *Bridgeton* and changing trends in maternity fashion. Notable recent guests have included Angelina Jolie, Oprah Winfrey and Hilary Clinton.
- *Woman's Hour* has had many changes of presenters over the years but has continued to track the changes and report on the issues that have affected women since the Second World War. There was a significant change of presenters in 2020 when long-running presenters Jenni Murray (33 years) and Jane Garvey (13 years) left to be replaced by Emma Barnett and subsequently Anita Rani.